

Pozole Rojo

Chile-forward · pork-rich · collagen-extracted · no shortcuts

YIELD	TIME	WATER	CHILE
4 L · 6–8	1.25 / 3.5 hr	2 L per kg pork	200 g per 4 L

TEMPERATURE TARGETS

paste fries to brick/burgundy; pork done at 195–205°F

Aromatics broil	500°F+ char	Chile toast	350–375°F
Pan browning	400–450°F	Lard for paste	375–400°F
Broth simmer	190–200°F	Pork internal	195–205°F

INGREDIENTS

2 L water per kg pork · 50 g chiles per liter

PORK & BROTH

Pork shoulder bone-in	2 kg
Pig's feet or 750 g neck	500 g
Water	4 L
Onions quartered	2
Garlic head halved	1
Bay leaves	2

CHILE PASTE — 200 G

Guajillo	55%	110 g
Ancho	25%	50 g
Pasilla	17.5%	35 g
Árbol	2.5%	5 g
Garlic raw		25–30 g
Cumin · oregano		3 · 1 g
Salt · peppercorns		3 g · 6

HOMINY & FINISH

Hominy 2 cans	1.6 kg
Lard total	~90 g
Apple cider vinegar	15 g
Salt	to taste
The spread: cabbage, radish, onion, oregano, lime.	

Two non-negotiables: collagen + simmer for body — the feet/neck and a lazy **190–200°F** simmer for 2.5–3 hr are what make the broth rich, not thin; and **frying the chile paste to brick/burgundy** in shimmering lard, which cooks out the raw edge. Bloom the drained hominy in that hot paste off-heat 15–20 min so it drinks the chile-lard.

Build the Pot

METHOD

broth 2.5–3 hr · start the paste at the 1-hour mark

- 1 **Broil:** onions quartered + garlic halved, cut-side up, 6–8" from the broiler, **8–12 min to char** (500°F+). Reserve 1 onion for the paste.
- 2 **Prep:** debone the shoulder, cube 2–3", reserve the bone. Split the feet lengthwise if using.
- 3 **Brown:** shimmering lard, brown the pork in 3–4 batches, 2–3 min/side, to build fond (400–450°F).
- 4 **Simmer:** add bone, collagen cuts, pork, aromatics, bay, water. **Lazy bubbles 2.5–3 hr** at 190–200°F. Skim at 30 min; start the paste at 1 hr.
- 5 **Toast:** dry skillet — árbol 15–20 sec/side, guajillo/ancho/pasilla 30–60 sec/side. Watch for the puff, then stem + seed.
- 6 **Soak:** off-boil hot water, submerge the chiles **25 min**. Reserve the liquid.
- 7 **Blend:** chiles + a cup of the liquid + the roasted onion + raw garlic + spices. **Strain hard**, rinsing with a little broth.
- 8 **Fry:** 4 spoons of lard, shimmering. Add the paste (it sizzles hard), vinegar at 30 sec, stir **3–4 min to brick/burgundy** (375–400°F).
- 9 **Bloom:** kill the heat, stir in the drained hominy, rest **15–20 min** off heat to absorb the chile-lard.
- 10 **Finish:** pork at 195–205°F → remove. Strain + skim the broth, add the chile-hominy, simmer **15 min**, return the pork 5 min. Salt; lime if flat.
- 11 **Serve:** ladle **70% broth, 30% solids**; tear the pork by hand into irregular chunks. Pass the garnishes.

TROUBLESHOOTING

better on day 2 — the fat cap makes skimming easy

PROBLEM	CAUSE	FIX
Thin broth	No collagen cuts / short simmer	Add feet or neck; simmer 2.5–3 hr min
Bitter paste	Burnt or old chiles	Toast less; a pinch of brown sugar if bitter
Pale color	Not enough guajillo	Guajillo = 55% of the chile mass
Tough pork	Under 195°F	Keep simmering — collagen breaks at 195–205°F
Flat flavor	No acid	Add lime at the end for brightness